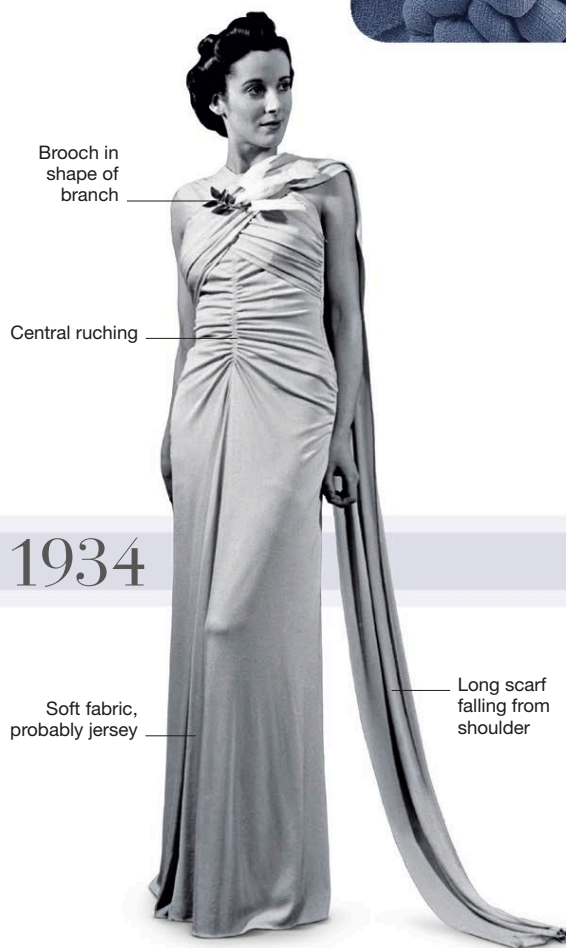


1932



Pink and gold French designer Patou's tulle evening dress is covered in pink and gold glass bugle beads, creating the illusion of drapery and folds. The shape of the gown is reminiscent of the Greek peplos that gave its name to the peplum (short overskirt).

1934



Scarves Trailing pieces of fabric, often attached to the shoulders, were a common feature of neoclassical dresses. The statuesque silhouette of this *Dove* evening gown by the English firm Motley is emphasized by the brooch and the model's hairstyle.

1936



Simple drapes White and black were common colours for neoclassical dresses, but Madeleine Vionnet chose a deep orange for this pared-down design. Fabric gathered at one shoulder is draped over the bust while falling to the floor at the back.

1938



Scrolls Unlike the evening gowns of the 1920s, neoclassical dresses were usually only sparsely embroidered so that the sculptural lines were not broken. The halterneck of this gown is reminiscent of a pectoral (crescent-shaped) necklace.

1944



Ancient Rome The Hungarian-born American designer Eta Hentz transformed the loose and more accidental drapery of Ancient Rome into an evening gown that left little to chance. This neoclassical silhouette is supported by a decorative border.

BRASSIERE

First patented in 1914, it was during the 1930s that the brassiere (a term in use at least since the early 20th century) came into its own. Rather than compressing the bust, it now provided lift, support, and separation. Kestos developed a brassiere with two formed cups. The brand name derived from the Greek *cestus* or *cestos*, the magic girdle or belt of the goddess Aphrodite. Kestos also developed special brassieres for low-backed evening dresses.



Kestos brassiere



Kestos advert